AEP FROM ZERO • PART 1 • KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER (AEP)

EPISODE 12

Adobe Web SDK, Datastreams & AEP Destinations

What is the Adobe Web SDK, what does a datastream do, and how do you activate an audience to an AEP destination? In this Adobe Experience Platform tutorial, Bloom replaces pixel spaghetti with one Web SDK tag, traces one click through five stations from the website to the Real-Time Customer Profile, and sets up an activation that sends two audiences to its agency through a file-based cloud storage destination. You will learn file-based versus streaming destinations, profile export versus

Previously: five audiences, still indoors

- Last time: streaming for 2 audiences, batch for 3
- The 9,930 estimate became a quality gate
- Problem: audiences still sit inside the platform
- Today, in: live clicks through one tag
- Today, out: two audiences to the agency nightly

KEY IDEA

The relaunch five are built and timed. Today live clicks flow in through one tag, and two audiences flow out to the agency.

Pixel spaghetti on Bloom's website

- One pixel for analytics
- One pixel for each advertising platform
- One more for personalisation
- Each slows the page a little
- Each describes the same visit differently

KEY IDEA

One tracking pixel per tool slows the page, and every tool describes the same visit differently, so no two numbers agree.

The Web SDK: one tag replaces the pixels

- Old way: one tracking pixel per tool
- Web SDK: one tag on every page
- Captures behaviour as XDM events
- Sends them to Adobe's Edge Network
- New tool later: a change at Adobe, not the page

KEY IDEA

The Web SDK is one tag that captures behaviour as XDM events and sends them to Adobe's Edge Network, replacing one pixel per tool.

The datastream: the router on the edge

Piece	What it does
Web SDK	The tag on the page; sends XDM events
Datastream	Routes each event to chosen services
Datastream ID	Wires the tag to one datastream
Wrong ID	Live clicks land in a practice sandbox

KEY IDEA

A datastream receives each event on the Edge Network and routes it to every service configured for it. The Datastream ID wires the tag to it.

Five stations of one click

1. A shopper taps Add to cart
2. Web SDK captures an XDM event
3. Edge datastream routes it
4. Lands in Bloom Web Events
5. Folds into the customer profile

KEY IDEA

Click, Web SDK tag, Edge datastream, Bloom Web Events dataset, profile: the same five stations as a batch load, at click speed.

Data Collection: Tags, Datastreams, Assurance

- Data Collection holds Tags, Datastreams, Assurance
- Tags: Adobe's tag manager for the Web SDK
- Datastreams: each with its Datastream ID
- Assurance: watch live events arrive
- Labels as of 2026; check your own screen

KEY IDEA

Datastreams live under Data Collection, beside Tags, which deploys the Web SDK, and Assurance, which inspects live events.

An audience that never leaves is a report

- Activation: sending an audience out to act
- Agency wants 2 audiences, every night
- High-Value Loyalists: the seed to find look-alikes
- Lapsed 90: Divya's win-back list
- Destination: a configured exit from the platform
- Journey Optimizer reads audiences directly

KEY IDEA

Audiences earn their keep only when something acts on them. Destinations are the configured exits; Journey Optimizer reads audiences directly.

Inside Destinations: tabs, filters, accounts

Tab	What it is for
Catalog	Every destination you could connect
Browse	Destinations you have configured
Accounts	Credentials, separate from connections
System view	A map of what flows where

KEY IDEA

Catalog shows what you could connect, Browse what you have, Accounts the credentials, and System view what flows where.

File-based or streaming destination?

Question	File-based	Streaming
How it arrives	A scheduled file	Server to server
How fast	On a cadence, say nightly	Within minutes
Typical partner	Agency, batch partner	Ad platform, retargeting
Cost	Lower	Higher

KEY IDEA

File-based destinations deliver scheduled files for batch partners. Streaming destinations deliver within minutes and cost more.

Profile export versus audience export

Export type	What travels	Ask yourself
Profile export	People, with mapped fields	Which fields does it need?
Audience export	Who is in the audience	Can the partner match?

KEY IDEA

A profile export sends people with the fields you map. An audience export sends membership for a partner to match. Ask which one the partner needs.

Building the activation, step by step

Catalog: a cloud storage card

▼

Click Activate audiences

▼

Select audiences: 2 of the 5

▼

Scheduling: the nightly file

▼

Mapping: source to target fields

▼

Review, before anything goes out

KEY IDEA

An activation is an audience plus a destination plus a mapping. The wizard runs Select audiences, Scheduling, Mapping, then Review.

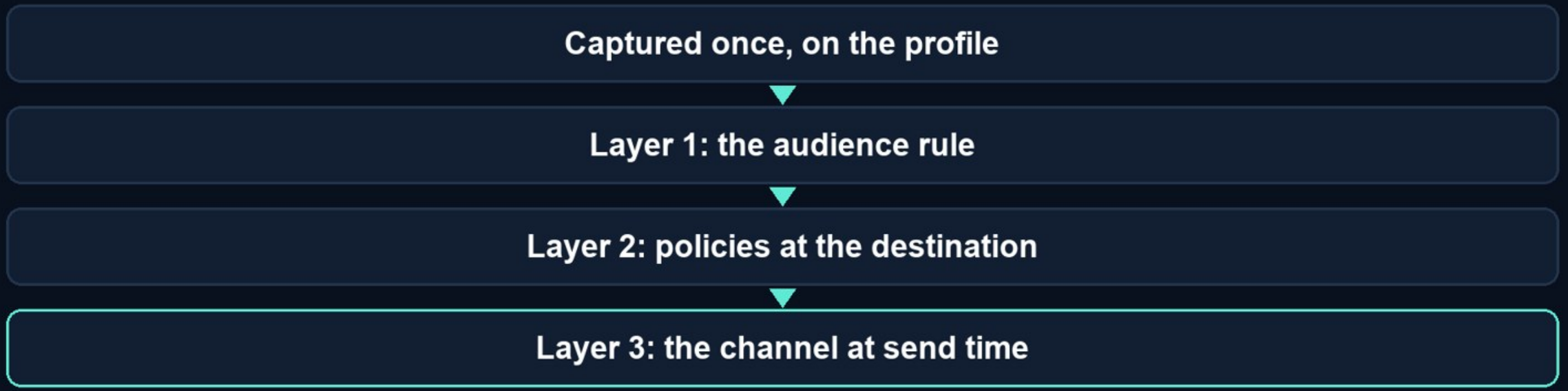
Hashed emails, and map the minimum

Requested field	Agency needs it?	Kavya's call
Email	Yes, to match people	Send it hashed
Loyalty band	Yes, to shape creative	Send it
First name, city, points	No job to do	Cut
Phone	Marketing insists	Flagged for review

KEY IDEA

Emails travel hashed so the partner can match without holding the raw address. Map only what the partner needs; every extra field is risk.

Does consent travel with the audience?



KEY IDEA

Consent is captured once, as data on the profile, and enforced in layers: the audience rule, the destination, and the channel at send time.

Interview corner

- Consent is a profile attribute enforced by the platform,
- not a process document enforced by goodwill.
- Activation: audience, destination, mapping
- Proof: Ananya can never reach the win-back file

KEY IDEA

Consent is a profile attribute enforced by the platform, not a process document enforced by goodwill.

Recap, your question, and Tara's condition

- One Web SDK tag; a datastream routes; check the ID
- Five stations: click, tag, edge, dataset, profile
- Pick file-based or streaming by partner speed
- Hashed email, minimum mapping, consent in layers
- Next: labels, policies and getting blocked

KEY IDEA

One tag in, a nightly file out, minimum fields, consent in layers. Next: Tara's condition, labels and policies.